



ENERGY WATCH

POLESTAR INSIGHTS

REPORTING PERIOD: 4 SEPTEMBER 2026 - 10 SEPTEMBER 2026

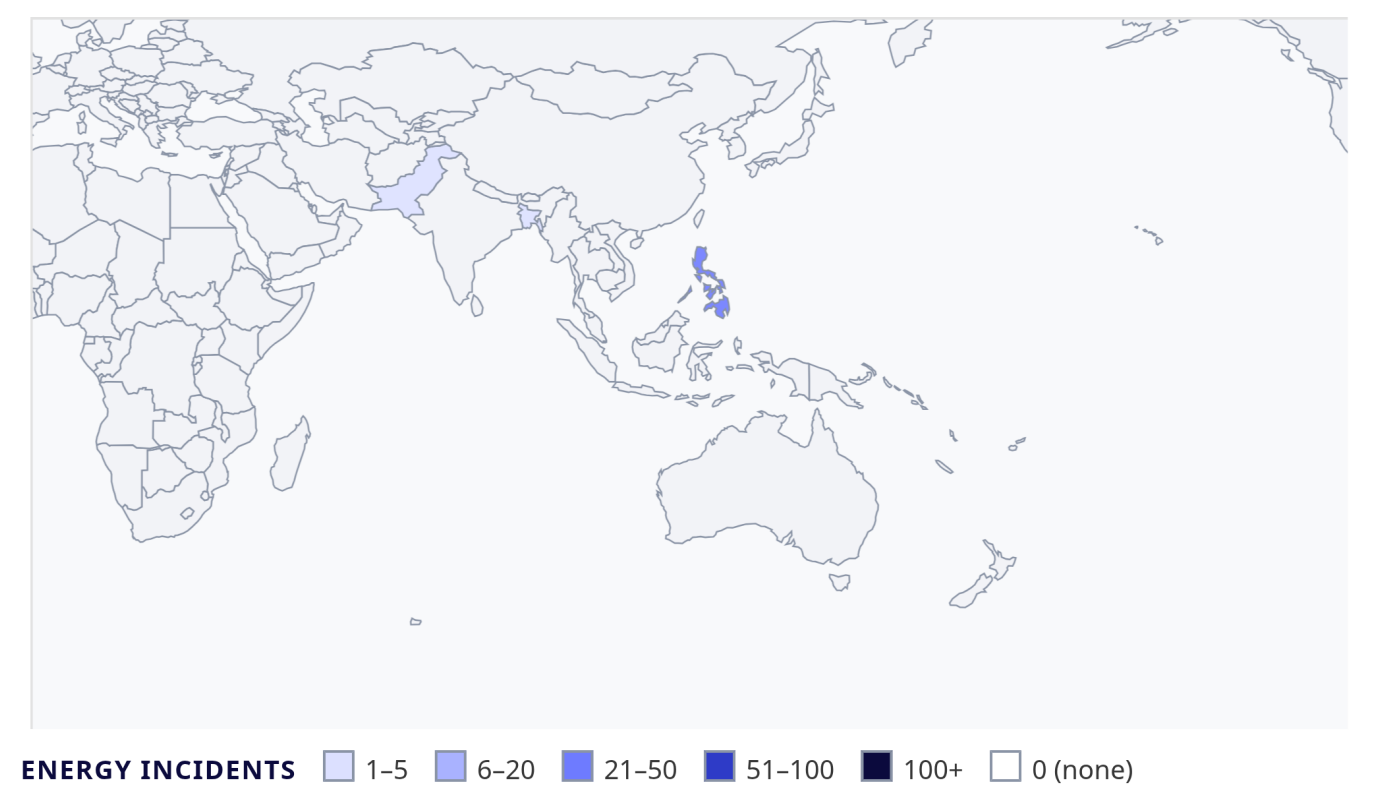
FAST FACTS

REPORTING PERIOD 4 Sep - 10 Sep 2026	MOST AFFECTED COUNTRY Philippines 25 records	POWER SUPPLY Longer brownouts Cebu faces longer brownouts as Visayas power shortage worsens
INFRASTRUCTURE OUTAGE Substation fire Substation fire cuts power to parts of Dhaka for hours	ELECTRICITY COSTS Higher electricity costs Brownouts now, higher Visayas power bills in September	BUSINESS IMPACT Market vendors affected Colon Night Market vendors grapple with rotational brownouts

BLUF

This window shows sustained power stress in two areas: Dhaka and the wider Bangladesh load-shedding picture, and the Visayas grid in the Philippines. The most acute single disruption was a High severity substation fire that cut power to parts of Dhaka for hours, while Moderate severity reporting from the Philippines points to a worsening regional shortage rather than a one-off fault. Operational pressure is most likely to come through outages, unstable power supply and knock-on disruption to site activity and travel timing.

ENERGY SITUATION



MARKET PRICES

ELECTRICITY (US CITY AVG)

US city average retail electricity

0.197 USD/kWh

-0.5% MoM



As of Jul 2026 · BLS / FRED (APU000072610)

NATURAL GAS (EUROPE)

EU import natural gas

17.93 USD/MMBtu

+18.8% MoM



As of Jul 2026 · IMF / FRED (PNGASEUUSDM)

NATURAL GAS (HENRY HUB)

Henry Hub natural gas spot

2.810 USD/MMBtu

-2.4% 7d



As of 09 Sep 2026 · EIA / FRED (DHHNGSP)

THERMAL COAL (AUSTRALIA)

Australian thermal coal

140.4 USD/mt

-6.6% MoM



As of Jul 2026 · IMF / FRED (PCOALAUUSDM)

ENERGY SITUATION

BANGLADESH / DHAKA

Power reliability remained uneven during the week. In Bangladesh, reporting centred on load shedding, with Dhaka repeatedly identified and public messaging indicating that some load shedding in the capital will have to be accepted.

PHILIPPINES / VISAYAS

In the Philippines, the issue was a broader generation and grid shortfall in the Visayas. Reporting described a worsening power crisis, continued outages and a return to red alert conditions, prompting moves to fast-track energy projects and calls for congressional inquiries.

BANGLADESH / DHAKA

In Dhaka, power disruption intensified around the weekend. Reporting said the city suffered its highest load shedding on Saturday, and this was followed by a High severity substation fire on 7 September that cut electricity to parts of the capital for hours. Subsequent statements indicated that some load shedding in Dhaka would need to be accepted, while other Bangladesh reporting focused on the social impact of outages and on official claims that June-July load shedding was lower than in the same period in 2023.

PHILIPPINES / VISAYAS

In the Philippines, the Visayas power shortage remained unresolved. Reporting from Manila described the crisis as worsening as outages continued, and lawmakers from Negros Occidental sought separate congressional inquiries after the Visayas grid slipped back into red alert on Tuesday afternoon. The shortage also prompted a push to fast-track three energy projects.

WHAT MATTERS

The immediate business effect is continuity risk from power cuts rather than physical insecurity. In Dhaka, abrupt outages can halt lifts, cooling, lighting, communications and payment systems, and they can delay entry to buildings while backup power is switched over or conserved.

In the Visayas, the concern is repeated interruption over a wider area. Continued outages and red alert conditions can disrupt working hours, cold-chain integrity, telecoms resilience and routine road movements if fuel retail, traffic signalling or local services are affected. Pakistan reporting on rising electricity bills points to cost pressure, but the incidents in this window do not show a parallel disruption event there.

IMPLICATIONS FOR BUSINESS

- Test backup power, UPS coverage and fuel availability at Dhaka and Visayas sites.
- Update outage response plans for lifts, access control, lighting and cooling failures.
- Build extra time into movements in Dhaka where outages can disrupt building access and local services.
- Review refrigeration, server and telecoms continuity measures in areas exposed to repeated outages.
- Confirm contact trees so staff can be updated quickly during prolonged power loss.
- Track utility and government statements in Bangladesh and the Philippines for changes to load shedding or grid alert status.

WATCH NEXT

- Further red alert declarations on the Visayas grid
- Any expansion of outages across the Visayas
- New details on the fast-tracking of the three Philippine energy projects
- Outcome of the congressional inquiries sought by Negros Occidental lawmakers
- Additional statements on accepted load shedding in Dhaka

- Follow-on disruption after the Dhaka substation fire
- Further tariff announcements or billing changes in Pakistan

POLESTAR VIEW

Risk level: Moderate. The most likely disruption remains unreliable electricity supply in Dhaka and across the Visayas, with the sharpest immediate impact coming from unplanned outages and the operational drag of repeated load shedding. Prioritise power continuity, check backup systems and maintain short-notice communications for any location exposed to grid instability.

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